Assessment 2: Experimental Report

Length	2,000 words ± 10%, not including the reference list.
Deadline	[Insert date and time.]
Weighting	65% of the overall module grade.
Submission	One PDF, uploaded to Canvas.

Your task

Write a **2,000-word experimental research report** in the style of an academic research article. Your report must answer one of the following questions:

- [Research question 1.]
- [Research question 2.]
- [Research question 3.]

Use published academic research to **develop your own hypothesis or hypotheses.** Use R to analyse the data and include **at least one table or figure** presenting your results. Write for **an academic audience**, following the structure and requirements below.

What to submit

Submit **one PDF** containing your student ID, your work, word count, and reference list. Do not include your name. Use your student ID as the filename and the submission title. Do not submit your data.

Writing your report

Use the following sections and headings:

- **Introduction:** State the research question and explain why it matters. Summarise what you find.
- **Literature review and hypothesis:** Explain what relevant academic research tells us about the question. Use it to develop a clear hypothesis: what effect do you expect to find, and why?
- **Data and methods:** Describe the experiment, its participants, treatment, and outcome. Explain the experimental design, how the outcome was measured, and how you analysed the data.
- **Results:** Present and interpret your findings. Explain the size and direction of the treatment effect, its confidence interval, and its p-value. Relate your findings to your hypothesis.
- **Conclusion:** Answer the question, explain what your findings mean for politics, and discuss the study's limitations and possible avenues of future research.

Analysing your data

If you need some help getting started, you can return to the materials from Workshops 6–9 and work through the tasks again using the assessment data:

- **Workshop 6:** Describe the experimental design and the treatment and control conditions, compare treatment and control outcomes, and calculate the difference between them on the outcome variable.
- **Workshop 7:** Estimate the treatment effect using a simple linear regression with `lm()`.
- **Workshop 8:** Interpret the estimate, confidence interval, and p-value.
- **Workshop 9:** Present your results in a clear table or figure and document your analysis.

Explain how random assignment helps you assess the effect of the treatment. Present your results in at least one table or figure with a clear title, labels, and a data source. Insert the finished table or figure into your report. **Do not** use screenshots of RStudio or copy results from other publications.

Sources and references

Use academic research to explain your question, develop your hypothesis, and interpret your findings. Use **at least five** relevant academic journal articles or academic books.

Use the Harvard referencing format for your in-text citations and reference list. Include every source you cite in the reference list at the end of your report. For example:

- **In-text citation:** Scott (2022) finds that graduates become more socially liberal.
- **Reference list:** Scott, R. (2022). 'Does university make you more liberal? Estimating the within-individual effects of higher education on political values', *Electoral Studies*, 77, 102471. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2022.102471.

How your work will be assessed

Your final mark will reflect:

- The **clarity** of your argument and the **relevance** of your hypothesis.
- The **accuracy** of your analysis and the **presentation** of your results.
- Your **interpretation** of the treatment effect, uncertainty, political significance, and limitations.
- The **quality** of your writing and your use of **academic** references.

Getting help

- **Assessment-support session:** In Workshop 10 in teaching Week 11, you can get started on your assignment in class with help from your workshop tutor.
- **Office hours:** Book an appointment with me or your workshop tutor for help with your question, data analysis, or a draft. You can find booking links and assessment guidance on Canvas.

For technical problems with submission, contact Student Support.

Note that **we cannot grant extensions**. Contact Student Support to request one.